

Board of Works July 8, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CHaTBpTMfu0
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Muncie Board of Public Works and Safety — Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: July 8, 2025

Report Release: Civic Analysis Report

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

No statutory public hearings or committee work sessions were held immediately prior to the regular meeting.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer opened the July 8, 2025 meeting of the Muncie Board of Public Works and Safety at **00:00:14**, beginning with the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Jeff Green, Lola Mauer, and Aaron White.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly designated by title, though led proceedings.
 - **Members Absent:** None.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance 00:00:21. Presiding members also noted that this would be Alan White's final board meeting before relocating to practice law, thanking him for his service 00:02:24.
 - **Approval of Minutes:**
 - **Item:** Approval of the minutes from the July 1st meeting 00:00:39.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:00:52.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- 00:00:59 **Register of Claims**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Craig Wright, City Controller.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Controller Wright reported that claims included standard health care claims, utilities, and medical testing screenings for the fire department per contract. A second run of utilities from the previous week included AT&T Mobility Center, Point Energy, and Comcast.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion made and seconded to approve claims totaling \$712,240.44; Approved by Voice Vote 00:01:48.
 - 00:02:39 **Street Closure Application: Muncie Action Plan (Two Dollar Tour)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Heather Williams and Krista Flynn, Muncie Action Plan.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The presenters submitted their yearly street closure request for the "Two Dollar Tour." The event is being expanded this year to include the closure of Martin Street (in addition to University Avenue) to create a clearer connection between campus and the village. The closure coordinates with Student Voluntary Services and a campus event to direct students toward the village and an evening Three Trails concert. Paperwork included sign-offs from the police chief, Ball State police chief, and fire chief.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:04:24.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- 00:04:35 **Melvin Kelly**
 - **Affiliation:** Executive Director, Brothers to Brothers
 - **Key Concerns:** Appeared before the board regarding a proposed back-to-school community celebration for children and families. Requested to close 5th Street between Elm and Jefferson on August 8th for bounce houses and food. Board

directed staff member Lacy to assist him with the required paperwork and approvals from the police and fire chiefs.

- **00:05:53 Mr. Bilbrey**

- **Affiliation:** Resident / Public Commenter
- **Key Concerns:** Raised procedural concerns regarding professional services contracts for Jeff Howe (MRC Director, recently appointed deputy mayor, and acting mayor). Stated that the initial February 2024 contract and a subsequent December 2024 addendum were never brought before or voted on by the Board of Works in a public meeting. Questioned why a third addendum was brought last week when the employee had allegedly been operating under it since May 21st without prior board approval. Noted that the Muncie City Council announced an investigation into the matter on Monday evening, reminding the board of its role as a check and balance.

- **00:09:28 Rick Gentry**

- **Affiliation:** Newsman, author
- **Key Concerns:** Inquired about the financial compensation being paid to Jeff Howe from taxpayer funds under the professional services contract/addendum discussed during the previous meeting.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Board members noted administrative procedures for upcoming street closure filings and thanked departing member Alan White for his service.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was adjourned following the conclusion of public comments **00:10:03**.

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